



TECHNICAL REPORT

# Senso Comune Gallery

Design, commerce and compliance

---

*Unique paintings, sold from mainland China to buyers at home and abroad. What follows is what that costs, what it requires, and what is still unresolved.*

Prepared for Priscilla  
Date 2026-09-17  
Repository `senso-comune-gallery`

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## PART 1

# Summary

## 1.1 What this is

A site selling unique paintings — six in the catalogue at the time of writing, priced \$60–\$440 — run by one non-technical person resident in mainland China, addressed equally to international and domestic buyers.

That last sentence contains most of the difficulty. A gallery site for a handful of works is an afternoon's work. A gallery site for a handful of works that takes money across the Chinese border, ships physical objects internationally, satisfies two consumer-law regimes at once and loads acceptably on both sides of the Great Firewall is not.

Nothing in the build is fixed to six. The count, the year span, the counters and the page set are all derived from the work data; adding a seventh is a data edit.

## 1.2 The seven findings that would have sunk it

Table 1: Blocking findings, in the order they must be dealt with

| Ref  | Finding                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A-01 | Every call to action was #A19E97 — <b>2.67:1</b> , failing both the body-text and the large-text floor. No font size rescues it.                                                                         |
| B-01 | <b>Stripe</b> is unavailable to a mainland-China seller — the whole account, not merely PayPal. <b>Airwallex</b> excludes mainland entities from card acquiring and opens no individual accounts at all. |
| B-03 | <code>vercel.app</code> and <code>workers.dev</code> measure <b>100% blocked</b> from mainland China. <code>pages.dev</code> measures 0%.                                                                |
| B-05 | A unique pre-existing painting gets <b>no returns exception</b> under either Chinese or EU law. Uniqueness is not personalisation.                                                                       |
| B-06 | Instagram was the only contact channel. It is blocked in mainland China, and EU law requires an email address regardless.                                                                                |
| B-08 | <b>China-origin paintings are not duty-free into the United States.</b> Section 301 adds 7.5% and the \$800 de minimis exemption is suspended.                                                           |
| N-01 | A one-page site cannot link to one painting, which is the site's main acquisition motion.                                                                                                                |

## 1.3 Decisions taken

### Settled

**Launch as an individual**, with the Hong Kong entity reachable as a configuration change rather than a rebuild. Under CNY 100,000 annual turnover there is no business-registration requirement, no foreign-exchange quota consumed, no balance-of-payments filing and no VAT.

**Host on Cloudflare Pages.** The only option with no bill, no pause, no terms problem and no ICP filing.

**Seven documents per language, not one.** The editorial scroll is kept; two lines of CSS (@view-transition) restore the single-page feel.

**Self-host the fonts.** 79.8 KB for both families, built from the variable originals.

**Adopt Priscilla's sage palette**, with text moved onto cream.

## 1.4 Cost

Table 2: Running cost of the recommended build

| Item                          | One-off       | Annual      |
|-------------------------------|---------------|-------------|
| Hosting (Cloudflare Pages)    | \$0           | \$0         |
| Domain (registrar at cost)    | —             | \$11        |
| Fonts, licensing (SIL OFL)    | \$0           | \$0         |
| Analytics                     | \$0           | \$0         |
| Photography, phone build      | \$6–25        | —           |
| Photography, full build       | \$360–400     | —           |
| Copyright registration, batch | \$85          | —           |
| <b>Total, minimum viable</b>  | <b>\$6–25</b> | <b>\$11</b> |

Payment processing is separate and depends on the entity decision; see Section 3.1.

## PART 2

# Design

## 2.1 Where the design came from

Priscilla supplied a nine-page draft and, later, a live mockup with a revised palette. Both were treated as the brief. The work here was not to redesign but to find where the drawing and the medium disagree — and they disagreed mostly about contrast.

## 2.2 The palette

Priscilla's mockup moves the site from white to a sage-green world: a dark brown mast-head bar, warm brown text, terracotta, and cream plates behind the paintings. Two of her decisions were already right and are kept exactly as drawn — the warm browns, and a **filled** terracotta button.

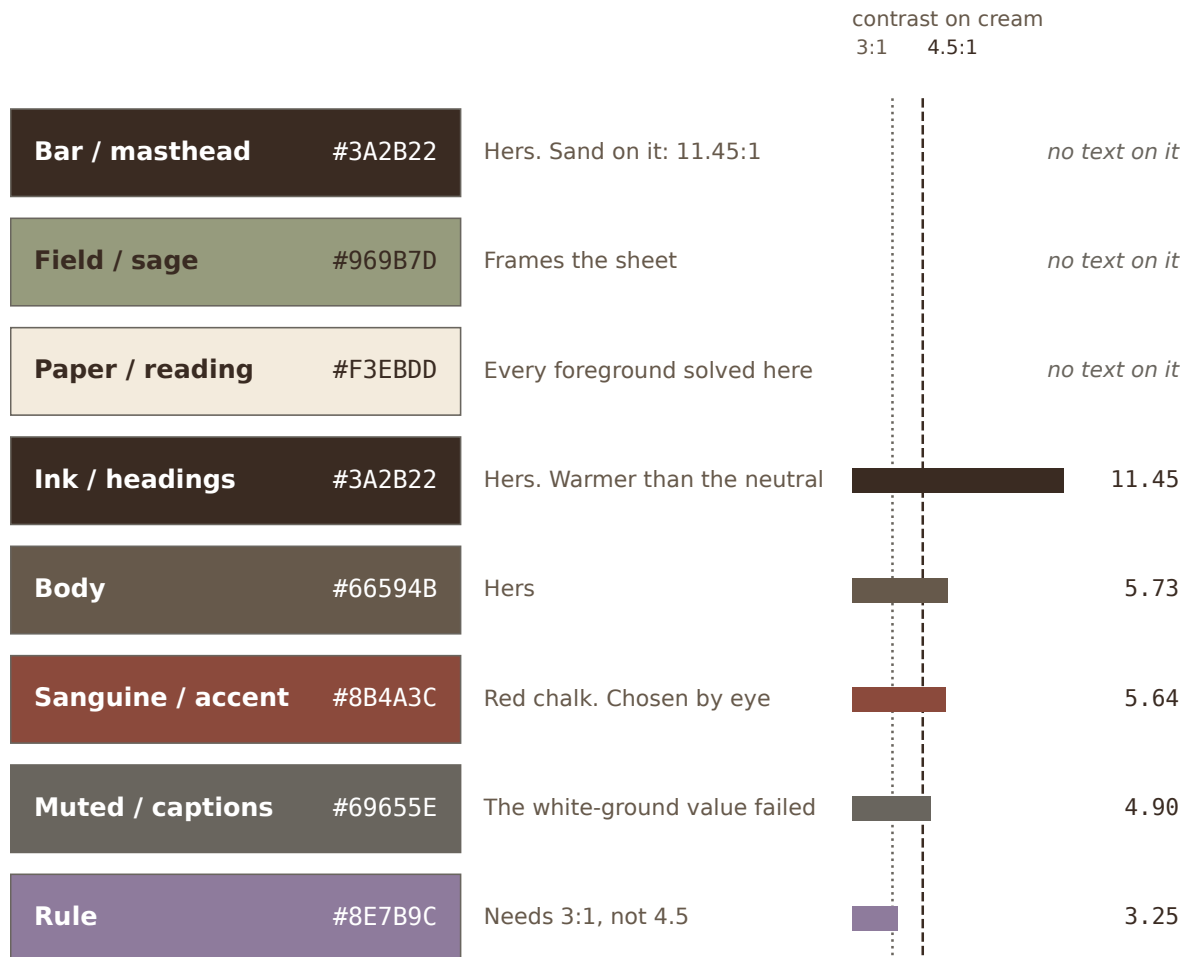


Figure 1: The palette as built. Each value is read from the project's token file, not transcribed.

2.2.1 What could not be adopted as drawn

Body text on the sage does not pass, and the accent on sage is worse than the value it was replacing.

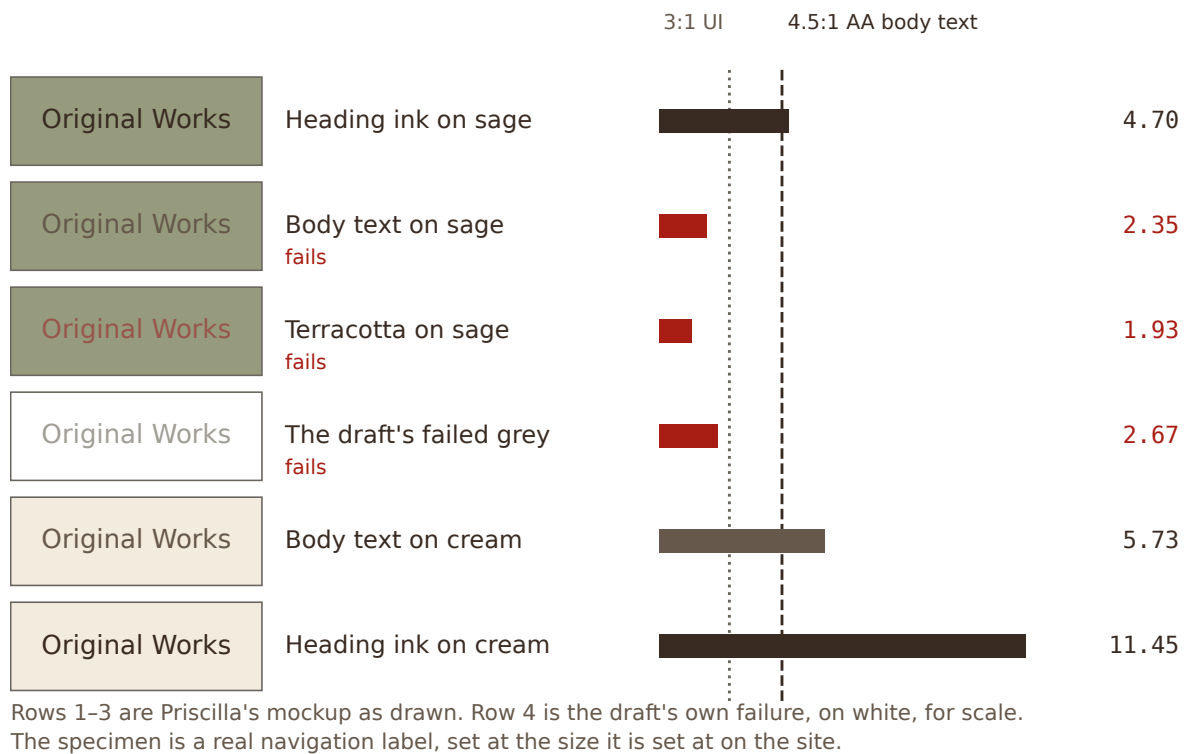


Figure 2: Why the sage carries no text. The three red bars are Priscilla’s mockup as drawn; the draft’s original failure is included for scale.

The resolution was already in her own mockup

She sets the paintings on light cream plates against the sage. So sage becomes the **field** and cream the **reading surface** — the whole content column is a cream sheet mounted on sage, which is what a gallery does to a work on paper anyway.

Her green stays dominant at the margins, the reading happens on cream, and nothing sets text on sage.

### 2.2.2 The warm-ground trap

#767676 is the canonical “lightest grey that passes on white”. On pure white it passes at 4.54:1, with 0.04 to spare. Warm the ground at all and it fails.

This caught the project three times — twice in tokens written specifically to avoid it. The response was to stop checking by eye: `scripts/check-contrast.mjs` recomputes every token against **the darkest ground it is ever painted on** and fails the build on a regression.

## 2.3 Typography

Two open-source variable faces, self-hosted: Fraunces and Inter.

Table 3: Font build, measured rather than estimated

| Build                                             | Bytes         |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Fraunces, all four axes                           | 121,124       |
| <b>Fraunces, opsz 14–40, wght 400–700, WONK 1</b> | <b>51,868</b> |
| Fraunces, opsz pinned                             | 32,500        |
| <b>Inter, opsz 18, wght 400–600</b>               | <b>29,856</b> |
| <b>Total, both families, latin subset</b>         | <b>81,724</b> |

Two corrections came out of running the build rather than reading about it. The draft sets Fraunces at six optical sizes — 16.0, 16.8, 21.6, 27.2, 30.4 and 38.4 — so the `opsz` axis must stay live; pinning it saves 19 KB and flattens the optical sizing the design depends on. And Fraunces’ `WONK` axis defaults to **1, not 0**; pinning it to 0 changes the letterforms to save 140 bytes.

### 2.3.1 The scale

Not the golden ratio. The one proportional system in Leonardo’s own hand, on the *Vitruvian Man* sheet, is whole-number fractions of height.

Table 4: Type scale, and how close Priscilla’s draft already was

| Role | Fraction       | Computed | Draft used |
|------|----------------|----------|------------|
| Hero | 1 (the height) | 38.4 px  | 38.4 px    |

| Role            | Fraction  | Computed | Draft used |
|-----------------|-----------|----------|------------|
| Section heading | less 1/8  | 33.6 px  | 30.4 px    |
| Sub-heading     | less 1/4  | 28.8 px  | 27.2 px    |
| Wordmark        | 1/6 + 1/4 | 22.4 px  | 21.6 px    |
| Body            | the unit  | 16.8 px  | 16.8 px    |
| Caption         | less 1/4  | 12.6 px  | 13.1 px    |

## 2.4 The mark

The site had a wordmark and no mark. On a business whose entire acquisition motion is a link in an Instagram or a WeChat bio, the surfaces that render most often are a browser tab, a share card and an avatar — and none of them can render a wordmark.

### 2.4.1 The constraint that decides it

The wordmark translates: *Senso Comune Gallery* in English, 常识画廊 in Chinese. That was a deliberate decision and it is the right one — a Chinese buyer should not have to read a Latin name to know where they are.

It also settles the logo. A favicon is chosen by **origin**, not by page: one file serves both URL trees, so a site cannot ship one monogram per locale however much it would like to. Any mark built from letterforms therefore serves one audience and decorates the other. *sc* is not the initials of 常识画廊.

#### This is why the first icon was replaced

The icon shipped in September was *sc*, cut from real Fraunces outlines. It was a correct solution to the problem as stated — *make something that reads at 16 px* — and it reads at 16 px. It was the wrong solution to the problem as it actually is, which is *make something that reads at 16 px in two languages*.

### 2.4.2 The options

Six were drawn. Four of them are eliminated by the same column of Figure 3 — the one that shows each candidate at the size it will actually be rendered at most of the time.

at display size 16 px



### Wordmark alone

WHERE THE SITE STARTED

Nothing to put in a tab. Illegible below about 90 px, and there is no second lockup for a share card or a WeChat avatar.



### SC monogram

WHAT SHIPPED IN SEPTEMBER

Reads at 16 px. But the wordmark translates, and the Chinese one is not spelled with Latin letters at all. It serves one of the two audiences.



### One monogram per locale

THE OBVIOUS REPAIR

Two marks is two brands. The favicon is chosen by the origin, not by the page, so a bilingual site cannot swap it per locale anyway.



### Leonardo's hatching

THE DEBT, MADE LITERAL

Announces the reference the brief asked to be carried quietly, and at 16 px it is four grey lines.



### Sfumato disc

THE PRINCIPLE, MADE LITERAL

A soft edge cannot survive a 32 px ICO, a monochrome fax of an invoice or an embroidered label. It has no outline to fall back to.



### A work on a wall

RECOMMENDED

Carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales. Its proportions are the catalogue's own: a 3:4 portrait hung at 144.78 cm on a 244 cm wall.

Figure 3: Six candidates, each drawn twice: at a size where anyone would approve it, and at 16 px, where it will spend its life.

#### 2.4.3 What was chosen

A work on a wall — the site's own structure, which is a cream sheet mounted on a sage field, reduced to three rectangles. It carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales and it cannot fall back to the wrong typeface.

Nothing in it is arbitrary. Every number is one the project had already committed to somewhere else.

Table 5: The mark, and where each of its numbers comes from

| Element | Value                                                | Source                                                                                                   |
|---------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Wall    | 64 × 64, <code>--bar</code>                          | The masthead. A piece of the site, not a badge applied to it                                             |
| Plate   | 28 × 37.33 — <b>3:4</b> — <code>--paper</code>       | The modal aspect of the catalogue, every work in which is portrait                                       |
| Datum   | Full width, <code>--field</code> , at <b>59.34</b> % | 144.78 cm on a 244 cm wall — the museum hanging standard the work-page scale diagram is already drawn to |

The datum runs the full width and passes *behind* the plate, so what is visible is two short sage segments either side of the work. That is what a hanging line looks like on a real wall, and it is the detail that stops the mark reading as a generic picture-frame glyph.

#### 2.4.4 Two renderings, one geometry

The wall is a **fill** where it can be seen and an **outline** where it cannot. In the tab, on the home screen and in this document's footer, the wall is painted. On the site's own masthead the ground is already `--bar`, so a filled wall would be no wall at all; there it is drawn as a 1.5-unit sage outline and everything else is identical.

Both are generated from `scripts/mark.mjs`. The report reads the same file — Figure 3 is drawn from it, not from a copy of its numbers — so the document cannot end up arguing for a mark the site no longer ships.

#### 2.4.5 What it deliberately does not do

- **It spends no accent.** Sanguine is 2.03:1 on the bar and would disappear at tab size; the sage datum is 4.70:1. The accent stays reserved for calls to action, which is most of what this palette is for.
- **It depends on no font.** An SVG favicon is rendered *without* the page's webfonts, so a mark set as `<text>` falls back to whatever serif the operating system has. Three rectangles and a line have no such failure mode.
- **It has no per-locale variant**, by construction. Section 2.4.1 is the reason, and the build asserts it: the masthead lockup is byte-identical on the English and Chinese home-pages.

WCAG contrast is defined on relative luminance, so converting the mark to greyscale leaves both of its ratios exactly where they are — 11.45:1 and 4.70:1 — and it survives a monochrome print unchanged. Two cases have **not** been tested: single-ink reproduction, where plate and datum cannot be separated by lightness at all, and embroidery below about 15 mm. Neither is needed before launch.

#### 2.4.6 Where it is used

`icon.svg`, `favicon.ico` at 32 px, `apple-touch-icon.png` at 180 px and `site.webmanifest`, all from one source; the masthead lockup, where the mark and the name are a single link and a single tab stop; and this document, in the footer of every page and on the title page.

Eight assertions in `scripts/check-review.mjs` hold it together: that the icon is the geometry `mark.mjs` declares, that the masthead draws the same plate, that the mark contributes no accessible name of its own, that it is identical in both locales, that it spends no accent, and that the hanging figure is the one the work pages cite.

## 2.5 Softness

The site as first built was correct and a little hard: square sheet, flat works, a colour swap for a hover and hard stops where sections met. This pass asked for something softer and more elegant — without making it less professional, and without changing a single colour.

Those two constraints do most of the design work. Every familiar softening technique reaches for new colour (a white card, a black shadow, a coloured glow) or for lower contrast (translucency), and this site has already argued, with measurements, against both.

#### 2.5.1 What limits it

Three commitments made earlier in this document bound what “soft” may mean here.

- **Quietness is bought with size and whitespace, never with contrast.** Anything translucent puts text over a ground that is no longer a token, so its contrast has to be measured against the worst thing that can pass beneath it — which, on a site of paintings, is white.
- **Edges dissolve rather than rule** (Section 2.6). A softer site should have *fewer* lines, not decorative new ones.
- **A painting is never altered.** Rounding its corner crops it. Zooming it on hover implies it was cropped to fit. Stretching it misrepresents the object for sale.

Motion has its own limit, already recorded in the stylesheet: many viewport-heights of large images make scroll-triggered movement a vestibular risk, and every animation must stand down when the reader has asked for reduced motion.

### 2.5.2 Research notes

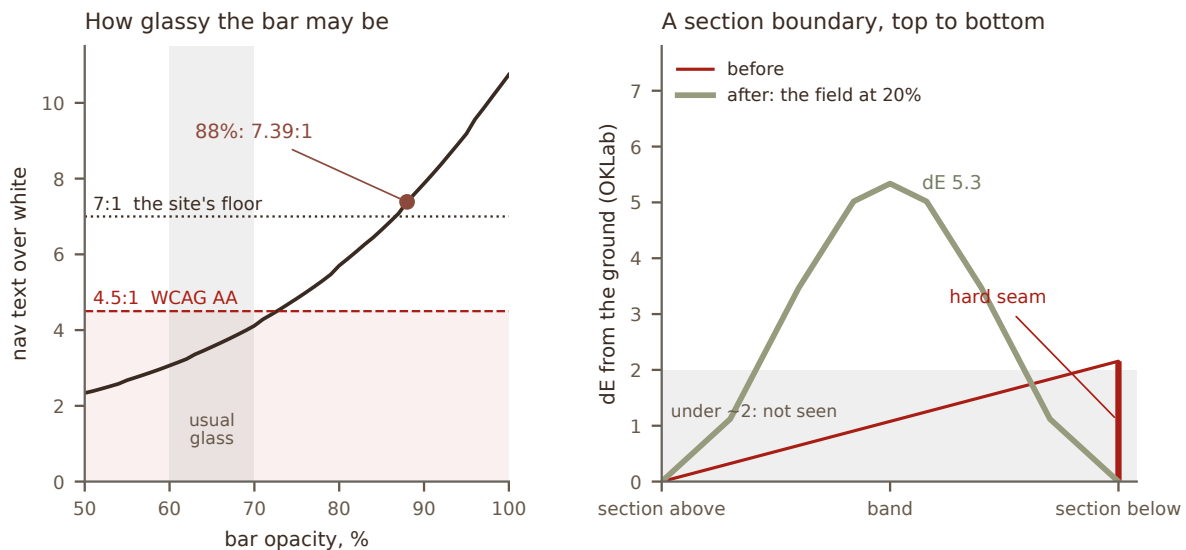


Figure 4: Left: how translucent the masthead may be, measured as navigation text over a white passage of a painting. Right: the lightness of a section boundary from top to bottom, before and after. Both panels are computed from the live token file.

**Glass has a hard floor, and it is high.** The usual glassmorphism panel runs at 60–70% opacity. Over a white passage that puts the navigation at 3.06–4.11:1: a failure at caption size. WCAG's 4.5:1 is reached at 73%; a full AAA margin of 7:1 needs 87%. The glass that is legal here is subtle by necessity, and the right-hand side of Figure 4 is why it is still worth having: a painting passing under a solid bar is cut off by a slab, while under 88% it is *felt* as a soft blur of its own colour.

**Glass at rest would repaint the brand.** Prototyping showed a problem no contrast figure reveals: a translucent bar at the top of the page sits over the sage, so every page would show a greyed, greenish masthead instead of Priscilla's brown. Glass is only wanted once there is something beneath it.

**The old section boundaries were invisible and hard at once.** The washes the sfumato bands faded between differ by  $\Delta E$  0.8–2.6 in OKLab — at or under the threshold of perception when spread across 9 rem. A boundary was therefore only ever seen where it

broke. Sampling the rendered homepage row by row found four such breaks, each a 10-level hard step (Table 6). The “soft edge” was being read as a faint line.

Table 6: Where the homepage's soft edges were hard, before this pass

| Boundary               | Seam              | Cause                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Hero → Works           | #ECE3D2 → #F3EBDD | The band faded to violet; the section below is warm |
| Tribute → archive link | #EDE4D3 → #F3EBDD | The link sat outside Tribute, on the bare sheet     |
| Archive link → About   | #F3EBDD → #ECE3D3 | ...so the next band started violet against warm     |
| About → How to Buy     | #E9E3D6 → #F3EBDD | No band at all                                      |

**A peak reads as a crease.** A boundary that rises and falls through a few evenly weighted stops draws a pointed profile, and the eye finds the point. The adopted band follows a raised cosine across nine stops, which is what the right-hand panel of Figure 4 plots — read back out of the stylesheet rather than redrawn.

**Motion on this site must settle, not perform.** The motion tokens already say *leave quickly, settle slowly, never overshoot*. Cross-document view transitions let a painting carry from the list into its own page. They need a unique name per element on each page; two elements sharing a name abort the whole transition, which rules out naming the lightbox copy.

### 2.5.3 Options

Every option considered is listed. **Adopted** items are built. **Optional** items remain available for a later pass, and where one fails a measured limit the reason says so.

Table 7: Softness options, by area

| Area       | Option                                         | Status                               | Why                                                                                                |
|------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edges      | 2 px on controls and panels, 3 px on the sheet | <b>Adopted</b>                       | Softens the pixel-hard corner without changing shape; a mount board is square                      |
| Edges      | 8–16 px radii                                  | Optional                             | Reads as an app, not a gallery                                                                     |
| Edges      | Rounded corners on the paintings               | Optional — <i>crops the work</i>     | Rounding a corner removes part of the object being sold                                            |
| Elevation  | Three-layer shadows tinted with --bar          | <b>Adopted</b>                       | A brown shadow sits <i>in</i> the paper; a black one sits on it and reads grey                     |
| Elevation  | Single large neutral shadow                    | Optional                             | Reads as a glow                                                                                    |
| Margins    | Passe-partout: a --paper-deep mat, no outline  | <b>Adopted</b>                       | What a gallery does to a work; defined by tone and shadow, not a line                              |
| Margins    | --paper mat with a hairline                    | Optional                             | Crisper and more card-like, but adds the line the site avoids                                      |
| Margins    | Shadow only, no mat                            | Optional                             | Softer still; loses the mounted look                                                               |
| Margins    | Sheet floating from 900 px, not 1320 px        | <b>Adopted</b>                       | On a 1280 px laptop the sheet used to run into the bar                                             |
| Glass      | Masthead at 88%, scroll-driven, desktop        | <b>Adopted</b>                       | 7.39:1 over white; solid at rest; nothing passes under it on a phone                               |
| Glass      | Masthead at 60–70%                             | Optional — <i>fails 4.5:1</i>        | 3.06–4.11:1 over a white passage                                                                   |
| Glass      | Translucent reading panels over the sage       | Optional — <i>unbounded contrast</i> | The sheet is the reading surface; text on glass over a painting has no worst case to solve against |
| Boundaries | The field breathing through each band at 20%   | <b>Adopted</b>                       | $\Delta E$ 5.3: plainly there when scrolling, a fifth of the way to the sage                       |

| Area       | Option                                                      | Status                                              | Why                                                                                |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Boundaries | Bands named by, and fading between, their actual neighbours | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | Removes all four seams in Table 6                                                  |
| Boundaries | Each section its own sheet, with sage between               | Optional                                            | The most emphatic; replaces one mounted sheet with several and doubles the shadows |
| Boundaries | The mark set small at the centre of a band                  | Optional                                            | A signpost that repeats the logo on every scroll                                   |
| Boundaries | A hairline or short sanguine rule                           | Optional — <i>adds a line and spends the accent</i> | Contradicts both principles above                                                  |
| Motion     | Nav underline drawn in from the left                        | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | A transform, so nothing reflows and the 48 px target is unchanged                  |
| Motion     | One-pixel button lift, pointer devices only                 | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | On touch, <code>:hover</code> sticks after a tap                                   |
| Motion     | Mount shadow deepens when a work is hovered                 | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | Elevation without touching the painting                                            |
| Motion     | Lightbox fades and settles 8 px                             | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | No scale: a painting drawn at 99.5% is drawn wrong                                 |
| Motion     | Zoom a painting on hover                                    | Optional — <i>alters the work</i>                   | Implies cropping; no hover on touch                                                |
| Motion     | Scroll-triggered reveals, parallax                          | Optional — <i>vestibular risk</i>                   | Also invisible in a link-card thumbnail and the first frame                        |
| Motion     | Animated focus ring                                         | Optional — <i>not recommended</i>                   | A focus indicator must be present the instant focus arrives                        |
| Navigation | Masthead held still across page changes                     | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | Without it the whole bar dissolves and re-forms, which reads as a reload           |
| Navigation | The painting carried from list to page                      | <b>Adopted</b>                                      | Chromium and Safari; elsewhere navigation is simply instant                        |
| Navigation | Smooth scrolling for in-page jumps                          | Optional                                            | A long glide past many large images; already declined                              |

### 2.5.4 What was built

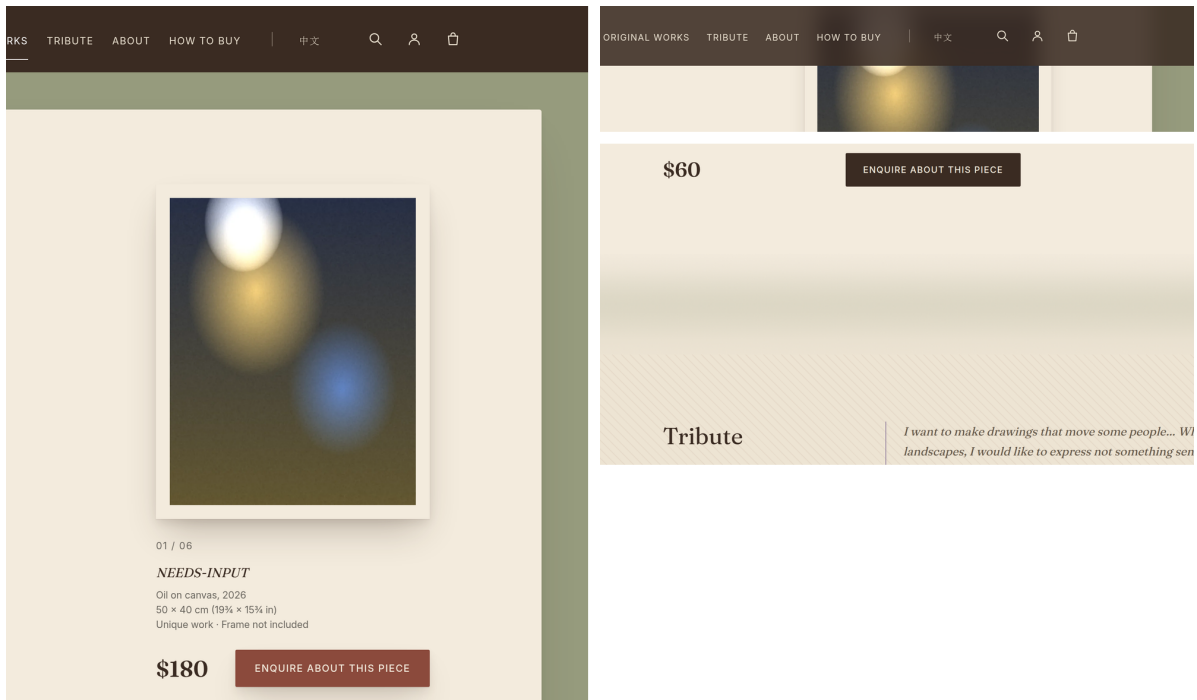


Figure 5: The adopted treatment, with a synthetic stand-in canvas in place of photography that does not exist yet. Left: hover — the navigation underline drawn, the mount lifted, the button raised one pixel. Top right: the glass bar at its scrolled state, with the canvas's near-white highlight beneath it. Bottom right: a section boundary between Original Works and Tribute.

Nothing in the palette changed. All nine new softness tokens — two radii, three shadows, the mat, the glass opacity and blur, and the boundary breath — are expressed through colours that already existed, and a check fails the build if a literal colour appears among them.

### 2.5.5 How it is held

- `check-contrast.mjs` composites the bar at `--glass-bar-opacity` over pure white and fails the build below 7:1 for navigation text. Set to the usual 70%, it names three failures.
- `check-render.mjs` is new, and the first check that needs a browser. It lays the built pages out in Chrome at 1440, 900 and 390 px and asserts that every painting's box keeps the painting's own proportions to within 1%, with no radius and no transform. It is not part of `npm run check`, which must run anywhere; CI runs it on every deploy.

Forcing the hero full-width under its height cap makes it report a 17% distortion by name.

- Six assertions in `check-review.mjs` (G-01 to G-06) cover the rest: no literal colour in the new tokens, a mat and nothing that alters a painting, glass solid at rest and gated, all new motion standing down for reduced motion, one transition name per painting per page, and every band joining the grounds actually either side of it. Each was mutation-tested.

## 2.6 The two masters

The brief asked for a debt to Leonardo and to van Gogh, carried without ever announcing itself. The test applied throughout: *a visitor who knows nothing should feel only that the site is calm and well made; a visitor who knows the work should feel recognised.*

### 2.6.1 What was adopted

- **The accent is sanguine.** Red chalk, the medium Leonardo drew in, measures 6.33:1 on white; the oxblood Priscilla chose by eye measures 6.68:1. They are the same colour. The recommendation was to change nothing and record why.
- **No hard edges.** Leonardo's instruction to paint "*without strokes or lines, in the manner of smoke*" and the Chinese 没骨 ("boneless") tradition of painting without contour are the same idea reached independently. For a Chinese painter addressing both audiences that is a structural principle, not a motif. Section boundaries dissolve rather than rule.
- **The rules are van Gogh's stated violet.** He told Theo the *Bedroom* walls were "of a pale violet"; they read blue today because the red lake faded. The site uses the colour he said, not the colour that survived.
- **Hatching runs his way.** Leonardo was left-handed, so his stroke runs upper-left to lower-right. No text source could be retrieved, so the 43.8° angle is an original structure-tensor measurement of his sheets, validated against a right-handed control.

### 2.6.2 What was cut, and why

#### The myth filter

**Golden-ratio grid.** Unsupported. Illustrating Pacioli's *De divina proportione* establishes that Leonardo drew the solids, not that he composed on the ratio.

**"Leonardo invented sfumato", and the word itself.** Cennino Cennini described blending shadows like smoke a century earlier, and Leonardo never used the noun — a full-text search of the *Trattato* returns none.

**Any yellow as text.** Indian yellow is 2.10:1 and zinc yellow 1.53:1. Both are genuine *Starry Night* pigments and both are unusable for anything but a mark inside an image.

**Sampling colours off the paintings.** The *Bedroom* wall as it survives today is 2.78:1; the *Sunflowers* chrome yellow 2.70:1. Both sit within a hair of the 2.67:1 failure this report opens with.

## 2.7 The site as built

Four views, at the two widths the layout was verified at. The screenshots are of the built pages, not mockups: what is shown is what `npm run build` produces — `docs/report/shots.sh` takes them from `dist/` over a real origin, so this section cannot quietly describe a version of the site that no longer exists.

## 2.8 The design review

The built site was reviewed again in September, as a designer rather than as its author, and the twenty findings were implemented. They are recorded here because several of them change claims made earlier in this document.

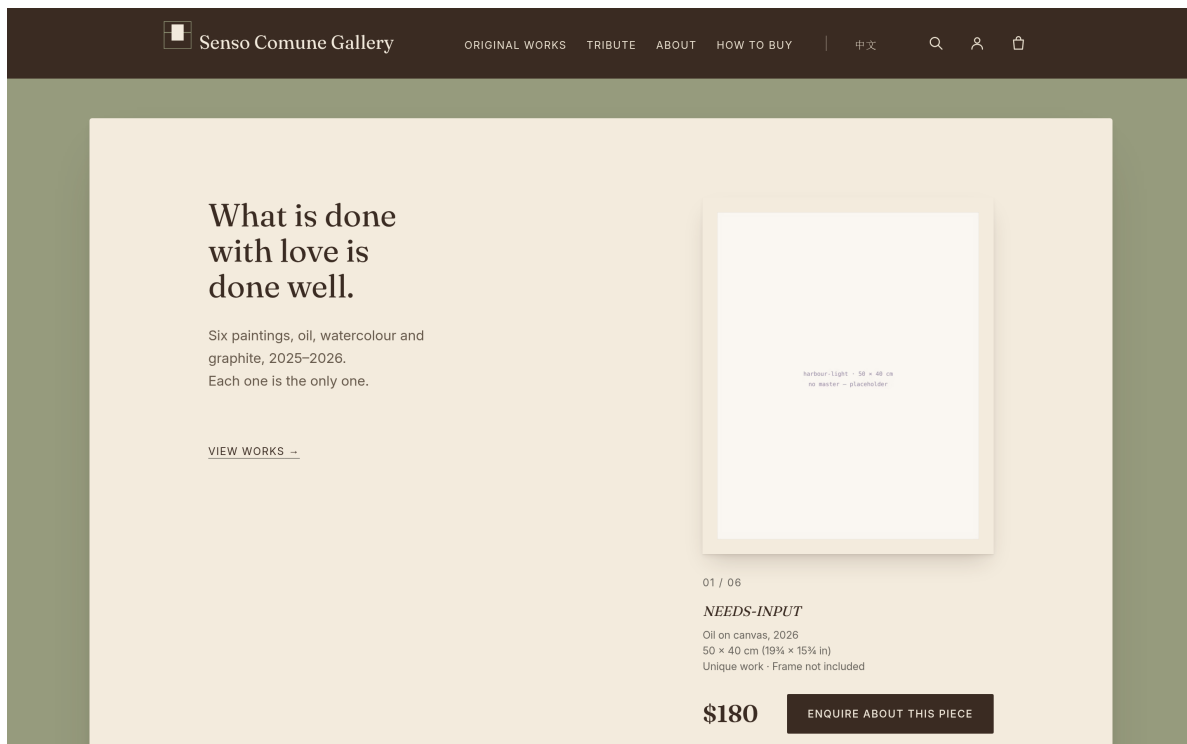


Figure 6: The homepage. Cream sheet mounted on the sage field, dark brown bar, the mark at the head of the wordmark. The first painting sits in the hero beside the motto rather than below the fold; the factual line under the motto is generated from the work data and cannot drift.

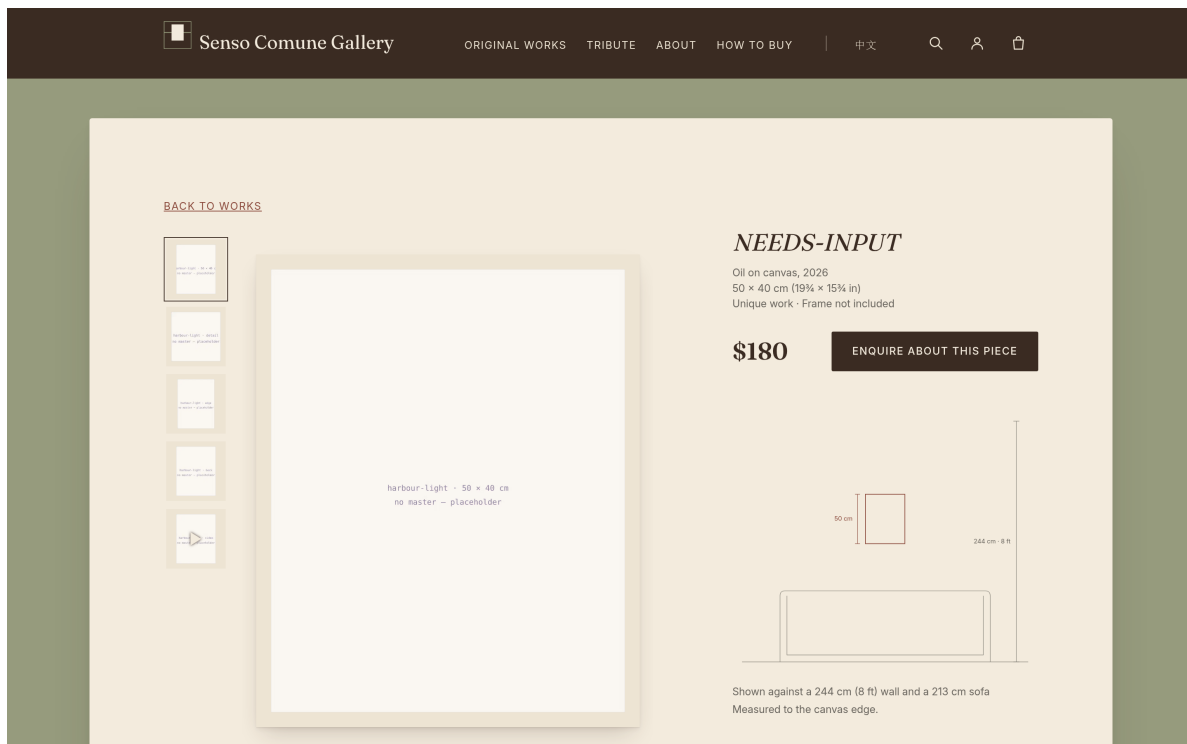


Figure 7: A work page, the painting in its mat. The price is the boldest element in the block — the single change with the best evidence behind it. The scale diagram shows the painting against a 244 cm wall and a 213 cm sofa, hung at the museum standard of 144.78 cm, which is also where the mark's datum sits.

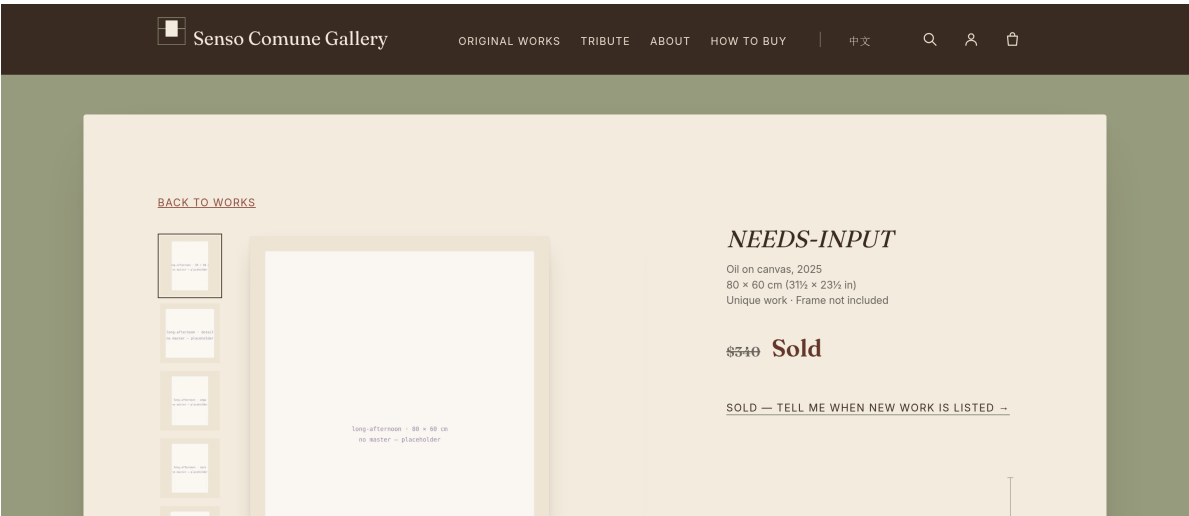


Figure 8: The sold state. The price stays visible as social proof, “Sold” sits at full contrast in the price position, and the call-to-action slot becomes a capture rather than a dead end.

Table 8: What the review changed, by group

| Group                | No. | What shipped                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A Selling            | 4   | A painting moved into the hero beside the motto; a <code>mailto:</code> link stopped calling itself <i>Buy</i> ; How to Buy gained reachable contact details; the price and its button were bound into one block                                                          |
| B Contrast and craft | 4   | A footer grey at <b>2.34:1</b> — shipped, not theoretical — was removed; the contrast checker was taught to resolve the cascade rather than read declarations; the scale diagram’s linework went from 1.73:1 to <b>3.24:1</b> and its labels from 3.05:1 to <b>4.90:1</b> |
| C Reach              | 4   | The icon set, <code>theme-color</code> and manifest (Section 2.4); Open Graph typed as a product with price and availability; the sage field restored on a phone                                                                                                          |
| D Reading            | 5   | Prose pages given a narrower mount; the archive set as a grid rather than a second selling gallery; the gallery name made the <code>h1</code> ; dead rules deleted                                                                                                        |
| E Fonts              | 2   | The Chinese subset’s coverage is now asserted at build time, and each locale preloads only the face it uses                                                                                                                                                               |
| F The mark           | 4   | Section 2.4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |



Figure 9: Mobile. The masthead is static below 720 px: at 390 px the sticky version grew to 280 px, a third of the viewport, and broke the scroll padding that the focus-obscured criterion depends on. The mark is sized in `em`, so it shrinks with the wordmark rather than needing its own breakpoint.

Two of the twenty were not fixes. **C-04** proposed freezing the wordmark in English; it was declined, and the wordmark still translates — which is what later decided the logo. And half of **B-03** was simply wrong: the review claimed the scale diagram's painting and sofa were composed off-axis. They are both centred, and always were. The contrast half of that finding was real and is the measurement above.

## PART 3

# Money

## 3.1 Paying

### 3.1.1 The constraint

**B-01 · Stripe is not available**

Mainland China is absent from Stripe's supported business countries. Hong Kong, Singapore and Japan are present. This is not the narrower finding about PayPal — it is the whole account.

Airwallex looked like the answer and is more restricted than it appears. A mainland entity can open an account for Global Accounts, foreign exchange and transfers, but card acquiring is excluded in Airwallex's own Chinese-language terms, and it opens no personal accounts at all.

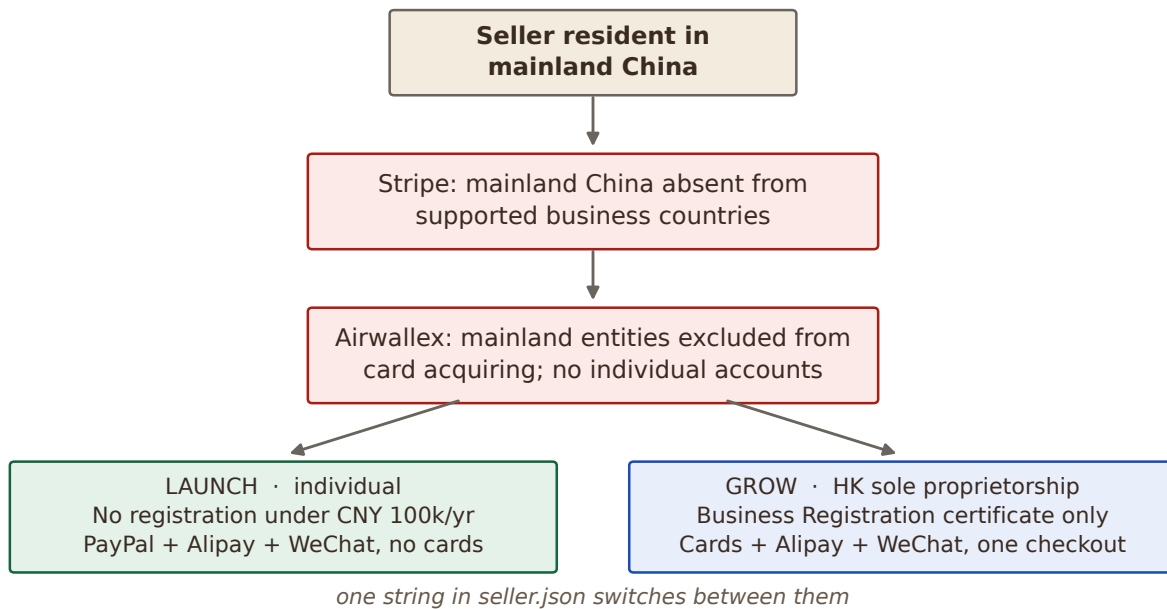


Figure 10: The two routes, and the one string that switches between them.

### 3.1.2 Route A — launch as an individual

At this turnover, four obligations that would normally apply do not.

Table 9: What the individual route does not require

| Requirement           | Position                                                                              | Authority                 |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Business registration | <b>Not required</b> under CNY 100,000/yr online turnover                              | SAMR Order 37, Art. 8 ¶13 |
| FX annual quota       | <b>Not consumed</b> — cross-border e-commerce settles outside it                      | 汇发〔2020〕14号 Art. 66(2)    |
| BOP declaration       | <b>Not filed</b> — resident individuals exempt at or below USD 10,000 per transaction | 汇发〔2022〕22号 Art. 8        |
| VAT                   | <b>Exempt</b> — monthly sales under CNY 100,000, to 31 Dec 2027                       | 财政部/税务总局 2023 年第 19 号     |

Six works at \$60–\$440 is roughly CNY 19,000 — an order of magnitude below the registration ceiling.

#### What Priscilla must not do

Route sale proceeds as a gift or family remittance; split transactions to stay under a threshold; or use informal currency swaps. The last is 私自买卖外汇 under Article 45 of the FX Regulations, and published enforcement puts the penalty on the offender's PBOC credit file.

### 3.1.3 Route B — a Hong Kong sole proprietorship

A Business Registration certificate is sufficient — no incorporation. That unlocks the free Airwallex plan with no-code payment links, international cards at 3.60% + HK\$2.35, and **Alipay and WeChat Pay** as merchant methods, which is how the domestic half of the audience is served from one checkout.

It also unlocks repatriation: Airwallex supports local CNY transfer for sellers without a mainland registered business whose ultimate beneficial owner is a Chinese national exporting goods from the mainland. That describes this business exactly.

### Confirm before incorporating

Airwallex approves its Payments product **separately** from account opening, and reviews the live site as part of that review. The entity list verified covers account opening only.

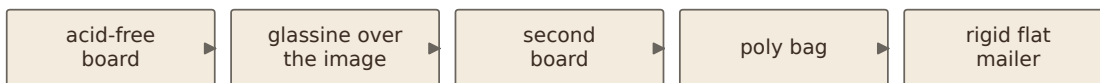
### 3.1.4 Rejected

**Payoneer Checkout** is Stripe-powered, excludes mainland China explicitly, and requires monthly volumes above USD 20,000 — roughly 130× this business. **PingPong** and **Lian-Lian** both have real independent-site acquiring, but neither publishes pricing or eligibility and both are sales-led. Do not design around either without a written quote.

## 3.2 Shipping

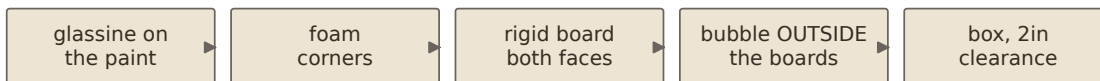
### Works on paper

flat, never rolled — rolling cracks the sizing



### Stretched canvas

upright, never flat — and never below freezing



Materials run \$25-50 per shipment. Every carrier's artwork declared-value caps sits above this inventory.

Figure 11: How each kind of work travels. The paper rule is the one most often got wrong.

### Works on paper ship flat, never rolled

Rolling cracks the paper's sizing and can crease or smear the media. Tubes are a fallback for very large **unstretched** canvas only.

Stretched canvas ships upright, never flat, with the bubble wrap outside the rigid boards so nothing touches the paint. Cold is a real hazard: linseed oil stiffens and can crack below freezing, which matters for winter shipping.

The much-discussed “\$1,000 artwork cap” does not bind here. FedEx caps declared value on art at \$1,000 or \$9.07/lb, whichever is greater; USPS additional insurance for artwork caps around \$1,000. Every one of those caps sits above this entire inventory.

3.3 Duty and tax at the border

B-08 · The site cannot say “duty-free” to US buyers

Original paintings under HS 9701 carry a **Free** base rate, which is where the belief comes from. For a **China-origin** shipment in 2026 it is wrong.

- **Section 301 List 4A applies.** HTSUS 9903.88.15 imposes **+7.5%** on products of China, and US note 20(s)(i) enumerates 9701.91.00 — contemporary paintings — among the covered subheadings. The exclusion that once covered paintings is expired.
- **De minimis is suspended.** The \$800 exemption no longer applies, so every painting needs a customs entry.
- **The IEEPA tariffs are gone** — struck down and revoked in February 2026 — and artworks were separately carved out of them as “informational materials”. That relief does **not** extend to Section 301.

A \$300 painting, China origin, delivered to the United States



Figure 12: What a US buyer actually pays on a \$300 painting.

Table 10: Import treatment by destination

| Destination   | Duty                     | VAT / tax | Confidence |
|---------------|--------------------------|-----------|------------|
| United States | <b>+7.5%</b> Section 301 | —         | Verified   |

| Destination    | Duty                            | VAT / tax                         | Confidence                        |
|----------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| United Kingdom | 0%, ERGA OMNES (origin-neutral) | Reduced art rate                  | Verified                          |
| European Union | 0% expected                     | Reduced art rate per member state | <b>Unverified — see Section 7</b> |

### 3.4 The donation pledge

The draft said “10% of each order goes toward research”, which is a per-transaction consumer promise. The site now says *“I personally donate 10% of my profits each quarter”* — a personal pledge, which is a materially different representation.

What protects the pledge is not the wording but the receipts: a public page with the recipient named, the basis stated, the cadence disclosed, and a running cumulative total.

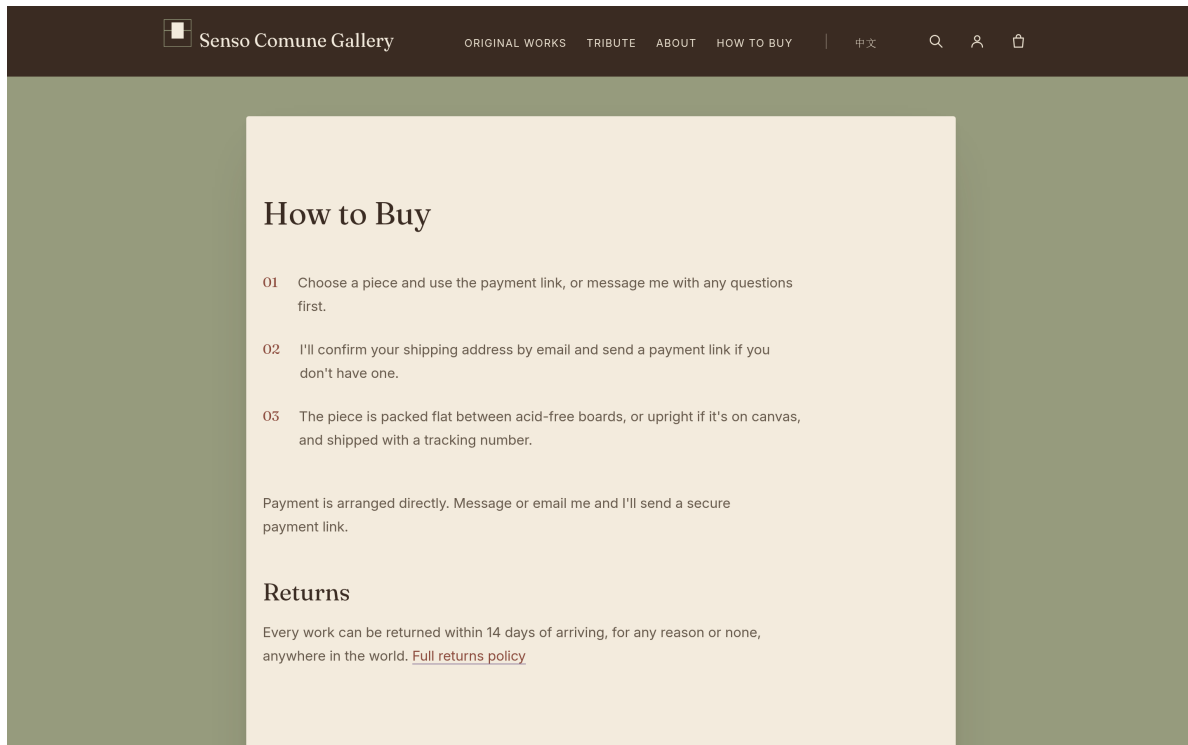


Figure 13: The How to Buy page, which puts the duty figure in front of the buyer before they commit rather than after.

## PART 4

## Law and access

### 4.1 Returns

#### B-05 · Returns cannot be refused, in either market

**China.** Consumer Protection Law Art. 25 gives a seven-day no-reason return on distance sales. The exceptions are a **closed list** — SAIC Order 90 Art. 6 excludes only goods made to the consumer's order, perishables, unsealed digital media and delivered periodicals. The 2024 Implementing Regulations Art. 19 then expressly forbid a trader expanding that list, and ban pre-ticked exclusion.

**European Union.** CRD Art. 16(c) excepts goods "made to the consumer's specifications or clearly personalised". **Uniqueness is not personalisation** — the test is whether the *buyer* specified it. A pre-existing painting chosen from a catalogue of six fails that test.

A "governed by PRC law" clause does not help: Rome I Art. 6(2) prevents a choice of law from depriving a consumer of protections that cannot be derogated from under their home law, where the trader directs activity there. Offering EU shipping at checkout is directing activity.

**One worldwide 14-day policy** over-satisfies the Chinese seven days, removes any need to geo-detect buyers, and avoids a seven-day policy reading as an attempt to shorten the EU right. Commissions are the one genuine exception under both regimes.

### 4.2 Disclosure

One block of address, phone and email satisfies three regimes at once: the EU Consumer Rights Directive Art. 6(1)(c), the Chinese requirement, and the UK anticipatory duty. Alongside it, SAMR Order 37 Art. 12 prescribes the exact sentence an unregistered individual seller must publish:

个人从事零星小额交易活动，依法不需要办理市场主体登记

That string is quoted verbatim from the rule and must not be paraphrased.

## 4.3 Privacy

PIPL applies, and costs a privacy page and a one-page impact assessment — no more. Processing necessary to conclude and perform the sale needs **no consent checkbox** — a just-in-time notice at the email field is the correct pattern, and consent is reserved for the newsletter. No PRC representative and no regulator filing are required, because those provisions bind handlers *outside* China. The overseas hosting is exempt from the CAC transfer mechanisms both as contract-necessary and on volume.

## 4.4 Accessibility

### 4.4.1 The legal position

Calmer than the compliance industry suggests. A one-person operation is almost certainly exempt from the European Accessibility Act as a microenterprise providing services. The stronger argument for the work is commercial: **a blind collector who cannot read the descriptions cannot buy the painting.**

### 4.4.2 What was built

Table 11: Accessibility work, by criterion

| Criterion                 | What it required                                                | Status                                 |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| 1.4.3 Contrast            | Every CTA was 2.67:1                                            | Filled ink control at 11.45:1          |
| 1.4.1 Use of colour       | No accent reaches 3:1 against body text                         | Underlines on body links, structurally |
| 2.4.7 / 1.4.11 Focus      | A single-colour ring dies over a dark painting                  | Two-tone ring, works on any ground     |
| 2.4.11 Focus not obscured | Sticky nav can hide the focused item                            | scroll-padding-top; static on mobile   |
| 2.5.8 Target size         | Nav bars are not sentences; the inline exception does not apply | 48 px via padding                      |
| 1.1.1 Non-text content    | Six paintings, no alt text                                      | Three-layer description per work       |
| 2.4.4 Link purpose        | Six identical "Buy" links in the links list                     | Visually-hidden span per control       |

#### 4.4.3 Describing a painting

The “125-character limit” is folklore — there is none in the HTML specification or in WCAG. The citable number is Cooper Hewitt’s **approximately fifteen words**.

The guidance genuinely disagrees on interpretation: the DIAGRAM Center says never interpret, Cooper Hewitt says interpret when it aids visual understanding. For an artist’s own gallery Cooper Hewitt is right — but interpretation stays textually separable, labelled “Artist’s note”, placed last, and never allowed to replace observation.

##### On AI-drafted descriptions

Acceptable as a first pass, never as shipped text. A model can report palette, format and apparent handling. It cannot know the true medium, the real dimensions, the title, or the intent — which is exactly what a buyer needs. A wrong description is worse than none, because it burns trust in the channel.

## PART 5

# The build

## 5.1 Shape

Plain Node, no framework. Twenty-eight pages generated from three data files, with sharp the only runtime dependency — which is the only architecture consistent with a design whose argument is restraint.

```
src/data/          seller.json · artworks.json · site.json
src/styles/        tokens.css · base.css · gallery.css
src/templates.js
build.js           28 pages, two locales
scripts/           mark.mjs           the logo geometry, shared with the report
                   build-fonts · build-fonts-cjk · build-images · build-icons
                   check-contrast · check-links · check-review · check-render
                   preview.mjs         one page, inlined, for review
docs/              brief/ · build-report/ · report/      one document each
```

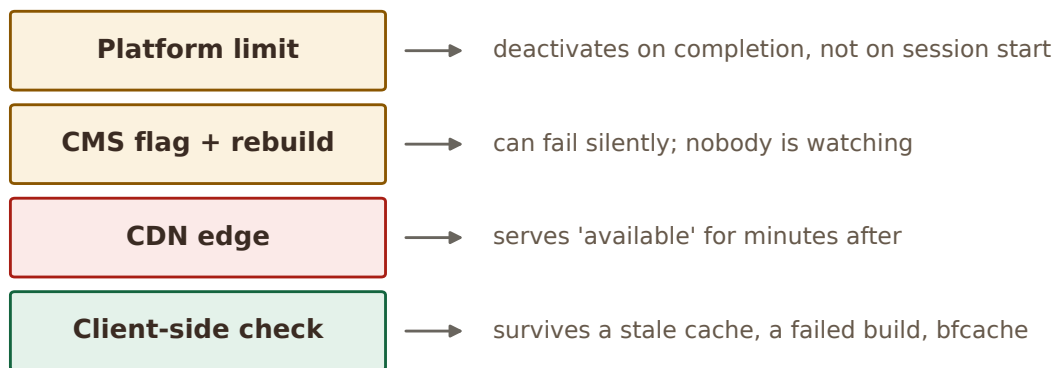
The page count follows the catalogue: fourteen routes per locale for six works, of which six are work pages.

## 5.2 The entity switch

One string in `seller.json` moves the whole site between the two commercial routes:

```
"activeEntity": "individual" → "hk-sole-prop"
```

That switches the published legal disclosure, the invoicing language, the checkout provider and the returns basis together. No template knows which entity is active.



No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The bottom layer is the cheapest, and the only one that survives the other three failing.

Figure 14: Defence in depth. Each layer above the bottom one fails in a way the bottom one survives.

### 5.3 Overselling

No platform in this price range guarantees atomicity. The client-side availability check is roughly forty lines and is the only layer that survives a stale CDN page, a silently failed rebuild or a bfcache restore.

Alongside it, a published policy costs nothing and settles the residual case: *in the rare event two people buy the same piece at once, the first completed payment stands and the second is refunded in full within 24 hours.*

### 5.4 Checks that block the build

Four. `npm run check` runs the first three anywhere; the fourth needs a browser and runs in CI.

`check-contrast.mjs` recomputes every token against its worst-case ground. It also resolves the *cascade*: where several rules set a colour on the dark bar, it takes the declaration that actually wins and measures that one.

`check-links.mjs` verifies dead links, missing `alt`, missing `width` or `height`, heading order, landmark counts, hreflang reciprocity, and that the shipped Chinese subset still covers every CJK character the build puts in a display position.

`check-review.mjs` is newer and differently shaped: **47 assertions over 30 findings** — the design review (Section 2.8), the mark and the softness pass — written against the

built pages rather than the source, so a fix that silently stops being applied fails the build instead of being noticed in a screenshot months later.

`check-render.mjs` lays the built pages out in headless Chrome and fails if any painting is drawn out of its own proportions, rounded or transformed (Section 2.5.5).

Between them they caught a muted grey that passed on white and failed on the darkest wash, work pages shipping with no `<h1>` at all, and a mobile override that made the navigation invisible once the dark bar was adopted.

#### A test that passes for the wrong reason

One of the review fixes set `font-size:var(--size-h1)`. No such token exists — the scale calls it `--size-hero` — so the rule silently fell back to inherited body size, and the assertion written for it passed because it only matched the declaration's text. The repair was a cross-cutting assertion that every `var(--token)` in the shipped stylesheet resolves to a definition. An undefined custom property is the one CSS error that produces no error.

#### The limit of automation

Automated testing decides roughly 13–30% of WCAG success criteria and catches almost none of the focus-order and focus-visibility failures that block people outright. The checks are a floor, not a pass.

## PART 6

## Next: the work page and the shop bar

### Status of this part

Written as research and scope; the decisions in Section 6.5 were then taken, and part of the scope was built. Section 6.6 records what was decided, where the decisions depart from the recommendations below, and what is built. The recommendations are left as written, so the reasoning behind each departure stays on the record.

Two requests, researched together because they meet on the same page: a work page that gives a visitor *enough views* of a painting, modelled on three reference shops, and the *search · account · cart* trio that sits top-right on nearly every shop.

### 6.1 What the reference shops do

Table 12: Three reference work pages, as they stood in September 2026

|           | +ART Gallery (Shopify)                                                              | Saatchi Art                                                                                    | National Gallery of Art shop      |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Gallery   | Left thumbnail rail: four stills and a fifth with a media badge                     | Left thumbnail rail: the work, a detail, two views in a furnished room                         | One image, no thumbnails          |
| Size cues | Dimensions in the details                                                           | Dimensions; room views; web AR                                                                 | Dimensions in the description     |
| Buy box   | Title, vendor, price with tax line; quantity stepper; add to cart; one-click wallet | Title, artist, medium, size, "ships in a tube"; price; instalments; add to cart; make an offer | Title, SKU, price; add to cart    |
| Assurance | Payment-method badges; accordions for shipping, delivery, contact                   | Shipping included; 14-day guarantee; review score                                              | None beyond price and tax         |
| Pressure  | "Hurry, only 1 left" bar                                                            | None visible                                                                                   | None                              |
| Share     | Facebook, X, Pinterest                                                              | Favourite count; add to collection                                                             | Facebook, X, Pinterest            |
| Header    | Search field, log in, cart with count                                               | Search, log in / register, cart with count                                                     | Search, log in, bag with subtotal |

Saatchi's is the closest model for a painter: it is the only one whose thumbnails answer the question a buyer of a unique object actually has — *what will this look like on my wall?*

## 6.2 What the research says

**Thumbnails, always.** Every desktop site in Baymard's benchmark shows thumbnails for additional images; 76% of mobile sites do not. Where only dot indicators are shown, half of desktop test users had difficulty finding the additional images, and users missed the one that would have answered their question. On mobile, a partly visible last thumbnail signals that more exist.<sup>1</sup>

<sup>1</sup>Baymard Institute, [Always use thumbnails to represent additional product images](#).

**At least one image in scale.** 42% of users try to judge a product's size from its images, and 28% of sites give them nothing to judge by.<sup>2</sup> For a painting sold unframed, whose size is its single most consequential property after the image itself, this is the finding that matters most.

**Different images answer different questions.** Product-page guidance commonly separates a plain view, an in-scale view, a close-up of material and texture, and a view in use. For a painting those become: the front, a raking-light detail, the edge and back, and the work at true size on a wall.

**No auto-rotation, and real controls.** The W3C pattern for a carousel requires a stop control whenever slides rotate on their own, stops rotation on focus and hover, and prefers a tab-style picker when slides are chosen directly — which is what a thumbnail rail is.<sup>3</sup>

**Icons need words.** Only the house, the printer and the magnifying glass are close to universally recognised; everything else — a person, a bag, a heart — is ambiguous without a visible label, and a label shown only on hover does not exist on a phone.<sup>4</sup>

**Search should be as prominent as search is useful.** Where people browse visually — Baymard's examples are apparel and home décor, and art is the same kind of purchase — a small search control is right; dominant search fields belong to large catalogues bought by specification.<sup>5</sup>

**Saving should not require an account.** Shoppers use the cart as a memory as much as a purchase, and a login gate is what stops people using a save feature; "favourites" is a better word than "wishlist".<sup>6</sup>

**Urgency must be true.** EU law treats falsely claiming limited availability to rush a decision as unfair in all circumstances.<sup>7</sup> A unique work *is* available once, so a scarcity bar would not be false here — but the page already says *Unique work*, and a "Hurry" is pressure the brief rules out.

## 6.3 What is different here

A shop template assumes multiple units of many products, an account system and one checkout for everything in the cart. None of those three is true of this site, and each one changes what the trio should be.

<sup>2</sup>Baymard Institute, [Provide at least one "in scale" image](#).

<sup>3</sup>W3C, [ARIA Authoring Practices Guide: Carousel pattern](#).

<sup>4</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Icon usability](#).

<sup>5</sup>Baymard Institute, [E-commerce search field design and its implications](#).

<sup>6</sup>Nielsen Norman Group, [Wishlist or shopping cart? Saving products for later](#).

<sup>7</sup>Directive 2005/29/EC, Annex I, point 7.

- **Every work is unique.** A quantity stepper has one legal value. “Only 1 left” is permanently true.
- **The catalogue is small.** Six works at launch, uncapped (Section 1). A search box with six things to find is a dead control.
- **There is no server.** The site is static by design. Accounts need authentication, password recovery and storage of personal data — which makes Priscilla a data controller under both PIPL and GDPR (Section 4.3) for nothing the buying path requires. The payment provider already holds the buyer’s record.
- **There is no multi-item checkout.** On the launch route each work has its own payment link, or is sold by enquiry; two works cannot be paid for in one transaction. Whether the Hong Kong route’s provider can take several line items in one hosted checkout is **not established**.
- **A cart widens the overselling window.** Section 5.3 defends a unique work from being sold twice. A cart invites a buyer to believe a work is held while it sits there, and every layer of that defence would have to re-check it.

## 6.4 Recommendations

### 6.4.1 The work page

**Five views per work**, each with a stated purpose.

Table 13: The view vocabulary

| View     | What it answers                               | Source                                                                |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Front    | What the work is                              | The existing photograph                                               |
| Detail   | What the surface is like                      | Raking-light photograph; the data field exists and is empty           |
| Edge     | How deep it is, and how it hangs unframed     | Photograph at 45°                                                     |
| Back     | Signature, inscription, hardware — provenance | Photograph                                                            |
| In scale | How big it is on a wall                       | <b>Generated</b> from the dimensions, as the scale diagram already is |

The in-scale view needs no photography. The scale diagram on every work page is already drawn at true proportion against a 244 cm wall, a 213 cm sofa and a 144.78 cm hanging line; it becomes the fifth view instead of a figure in the sidebar. Every work gets Baynard’s most-missed image on day one.

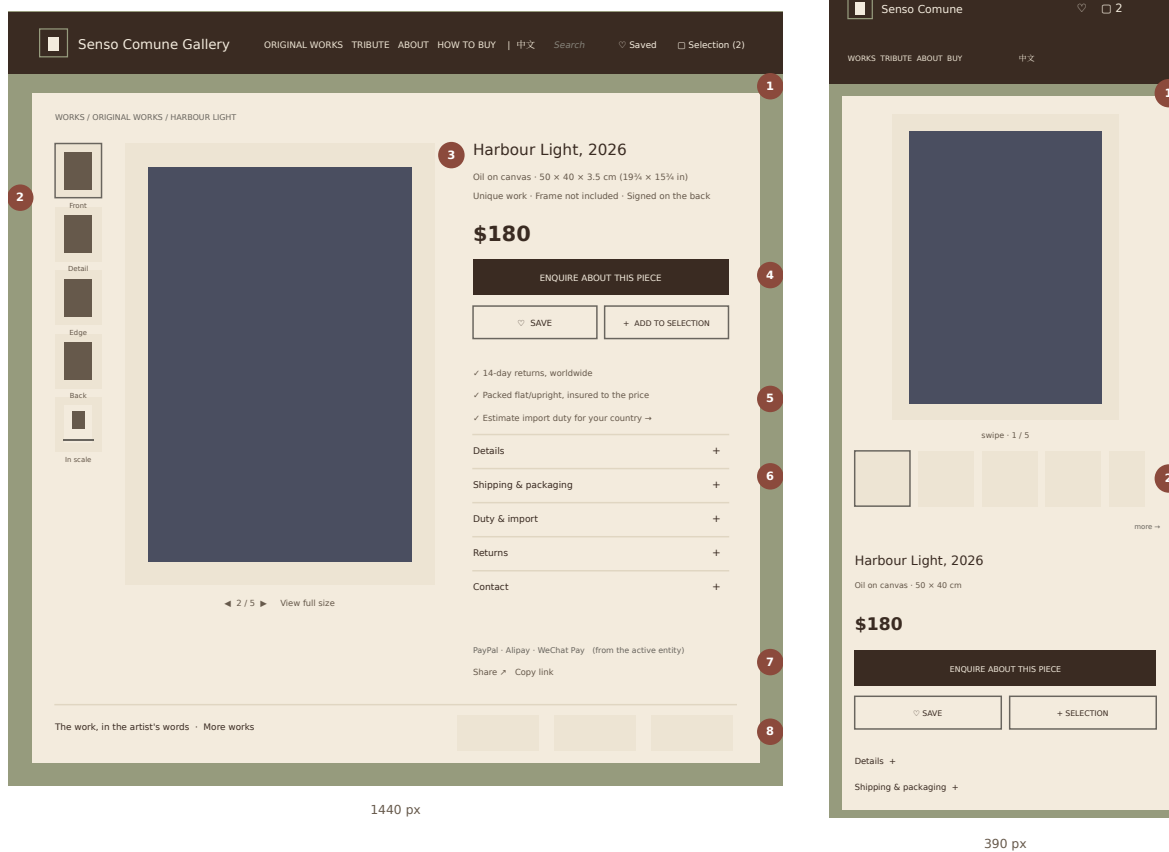


Figure 15: The planned work page. Numbered: (1) the shop bar; (2) five views with thumbnails always visible; (3) the current view, opening full size; (4) one primary action, with Save and Add to selection secondary; (5) assurance lines drawn from the seller data; (6) disclosures as native accordions; (7) payment methods derived from the active entity, and sharing; (8) the artist's words and more works. Proportions are schematic.

**A zero-script gallery, enhanced.** The views sit in a horizontal scroll-snap strip, so a phone swipes natively. The thumbnails are in-page links to each view: a rail on the left from 900 px, a row beneath below that, with the last one partly cut off. That works with no JavaScript at all. A short script then adds what links cannot: the current thumbnail marked with `aria-current`, no history entry per thumbnail, and arrow-key movement along the rail. The lightbox opens whichever view is showing. Only the front view carries the painting's transition name (Section 2.5).

**One primary action.** *Buy* when a checkout link exists, *Enquire about this piece* when it does not, as today. *Save* and *Add to selection* sit beneath it as quiet outlined controls; neither may outweigh the price, which remains the boldest element (Section 2.7).

**Assurance from data, not copy.** Three lines under the actions, each true and each already argued in this document: the worldwide 14-day return (Section 4.1); how the work is packed and insured (Section 3.2); and a link that estimates import duty for the buyer's country (Section 3.3) — which none of the reference shops offer, and which is the question an international buyer of a \$300 painting actually has.

**Disclosures as native accordions.** `<details>` elements: Details, Shipping and packaging, Duty and import, Returns, Contact. No script, keyboard-operable, and readable with styles off.

**Payment methods from the active entity.** On the launch route that is PayPal, Alipay and WeChat Pay and *no card marks*; card marks appear only when the Hong Kong entity is active. A card logo shown by a seller that cannot take cards is a misleading claim, so the list is generated, like the rest of the entity switch (Section 5.2).

**Sharing that works in China.** A share button using the device's own share sheet where the browser supports it, and *Copy link* everywhere. Not a row of Facebook, X and Pinterest buttons, all three of which are unreachable in mainland China; WeChat builds its own link card from the Open Graph tags the site already publishes.

Table 14: Reference features considered for the work page

| Feature                           | Status             | Why                                                         |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Thumbnail rail and five views     | <b>Recommended</b> | The research, directly                                      |
| Generated in-scale view           | <b>Recommended</b> | Answers the most consequential question with no photography |
| Assurance lines and duty estimate | <b>Recommended</b> | True, already argued, and not offered by the references     |
| Accordions for disclosures        | <b>Recommended</b> | Zero script; keeps the buy box short                        |
| Payment methods from the entity   | <b>Recommended</b> | Accuracy is a legal matter, not a style                     |

| Feature                                    | Status                    | Why                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Device share sheet and copy link           | <b>Recommended</b>        | The only sharing that reaches both audiences                                                                                        |
| More works, three at a time                | <b>Recommended</b>        | Available works only; the archive stays separate                                                                                    |
| Breadcrumb                                 | Optional                  | Useful once there are more sections; two levels today                                                                               |
| Short video of the surface in moving light | Optional                  | Heavy across the border; poster and on-demand loading only                                                                          |
| Web AR on the wall                         | Optional — <i>later</i>   | Native Android AR viewers rely on Google Play services, largely absent in mainland China; in-browser AR needs a commercial platform |
| Make an offer                              | Optional                  | The enquiry already does this; a form needs a back end                                                                              |
| Quantity stepper                           | Not recommended           | One legal value                                                                                                                     |
| "Hurry, only 1 left"                       | Not recommended           | True, but pressure; <i>Unique work</i> already says it                                                                              |
| Instalment financing                       | Not recommended           | Neither entity route has a lending partner                                                                                          |
| Review score                               | Not recommended at launch | No reviews exist; inventing them is unlawful                                                                                        |

#### 6.4.2 The shop bar

The trio as requested would put three controls in the masthead, and on this site two of them would lead nowhere at launch: a search with six things to find, and an account with nothing behind it. The recommendation keeps the convention people look for in that corner, and gives each position something true to do.

Table 15: The shop bar, as requested and as recommended

| Position | As requested | Recommended                                                 | Why                                                                                            |
|----------|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| First    | Search       | <b>Search</b> , shown once the catalogue passes a threshold | Dead with six works; built from a static index when it earns its place                         |
| Second   | Account      | <b>Saved</b> (收藏) — favourites kept on the device, no login | Saving without an account is what the research recommends; no personal data leaves the browser |
| Third    | Cart         | <b>Selection</b> (选购) — gathers works into one enquiry      | Matches how works are really sold; a real cart waits for a real multi-item checkout            |

**Selection, not cart.** Works added to the selection are listed on one page with their prices and a total, and one action sends a single enquiry — email or a WeChat message ready to paste — naming every work and asking for the delivery country, so shipping and duty can be quoted together. It states plainly that adding a work does not reserve it, and it checks `availability.json` when it opens, so a work sold in the meantime is shown as sold rather than silently kept. It becomes a true cart only if and when the entity and its provider can take one payment for several works (Section 6.5).

**Labels.** Like the language switch, 中文, the controls are words first. From 900 px each control carries its word beside its icon — *Search*, *Saved*, *Selection* (2), and 搜索, 收藏, 选购 in Chinese. On phones the icons stand alone at 44 px with the count as text, and each accessible name matches what is shown.

**Room on a phone.** The masthead was measured at true phone widths (see Section 6.8 for why that needed saying).

Table 16: The masthead's top row on a phone, measured

| Arrangement                                                      | 360 px<br>(320<br>usable) | 390 px<br>(350<br>usable) |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| Today: full name, language switch                                | 306                       | 306                       |
| Full name + two icons, language switch kept                      | 414 —<br><i>overflows</i> | 414 —<br><i>overflows</i> |
| <b>Short name + two icons; language switch to the second row</b> | <b>256</b>                | <b>256</b>                |
| Short name + three icons (search enabled)                        | 304                       | 304                       |

The short name is the one the web manifest already uses, *Senso Comune*: 116 px against 178. The Chinese name, 常识画廊, is 67 px and keeps its full form. On the second row the language switch follows the four section links (226 px), without its divider below 400 px, where it would not fit.

**Search, when it comes.** A small index written by the build — title, medium, year and section in both languages — searched in the browser. Substring matching serves Chinese without word segmentation, and for a catalogue of this size the index is a few kilobytes. It is switched on by one value in `site.json`; the proposal is when more than 24 works are available, which is four rows of the archive grid. That number is a judgement, and is listed as a decision.

**Account, not now.** It would need a server, a login, password recovery and a privacy regime, to provide an order history the payment provider already keeps. It becomes reasonable only if the site ever moves to a hosted commerce platform that supplies accounts — which would reverse the architecture in Section 5.

## 6.5 Decisions for Priscilla

Table 17: Needed before building

| #  | Decision                                                                                        | Recommended                                      | Blocks  |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|---------|
| D1 | The shop bar: the literal <i>search · account · cart</i> , or <i>search · saved · selection</i> | Saved and selection now; search at the threshold | Phase 4 |
| D2 | Which views can be photographed for each work: detail, edge, back                               | All three, to the shot list in Phase 1           | Phase 2 |
| D3 | Whether two works must be payable in one transaction                                            | Not at launch: one enquiry for several works     | Phase 6 |
| D4 | The number of available works at which search appears                                           | 24                                               | Phase 5 |
| D5 | Whether a short surface video is wanted for any work                                            | No, at launch                                    | —       |

## 6.6 Decisions taken, and what was built

Table 18: The decisions, as taken on 17 September 2026

| #  | Decision taken                                                                                                               | Against the recommendation                                                                                              |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| D1 | The literal <b>search · account · cart</b> , shown now, each linking to a placeholder route that lands on the 404 page       | Departs: the recommendation was <i>saved · selection</i> , with search at a threshold                                   |
| D2 | <b>Detail, edge, back and video</b> views on every work, as placeholders until the files exist                               | As recommended, with video added; the generated in-scale view was not taken, and the scale diagram stays in the sidebar |
| D3 | <b>Any number of works in one order</b> , limited only by availability and by the payment route's largest single transaction | Departs: the recommendation was one enquiry for several works until a multi-item checkout exists                        |
| D4 | <b>No search threshold</b> , provided the query and the searchable text are correctly scoped                                 | Departs: the recommendation was 24 works                                                                                |
| D5 | <b>Video on work pages only</b> , for now                                                                                    | As recommended in effect: nowhere else carries video                                                                    |

## What is built.

- **The shop bar.** Search, account and cart on every page, in both languages, as icons whose accessible names are the words (*Search, Account, Cart*; 搜索, 账户, 购物车). The destinations are placeholders by decision: each link is marked, its route is declared in `site.json`, and `check-links` fails the build if a marked route ever resolves — so a page cannot be built without its placeholder being retired in the same change. On phones the masthead takes the two rows measured in Table 16: the short name and the three icons, then the sections and the language switch. `check-render` now fails on any masthead overflow, on more than two rows below 720 px, or on a shop control under 44 px, at 360 and 390 px in both languages.
- **A bilingual 404.** Every placeholder lands on it, so it is built rather than left to the host's default: both languages, no canonical, not indexed, not in the sitemap.
- **The five views.** Front, detail, edge, back and video on every work page, in the zero-script gallery of Section 6.4, with thumbnails always visible. The image pipeline makes a labelled placeholder at a sensible proportion for each missing view — square for detail, 3:4 for the edge, the work's own ratio for the back, 4:5 for video — and a real photograph replaces it on the next build and keeps its own proportions, read from a size manifest rather than assumed. One 4.8 KB placeholder clip serves every work until its own video exists, so the preview build needs no video tooling. Video is never preloaded and never plays by itself.
- **Checked in a browser.** The gallery script was driven headlessly: a thumbnail scrolls its view into place, marks it current and adds no history entry; Home and End work along the thumbnails. `check-render` now measures 164 painting and video boxes across the four widths, and eight new assertions (H-01 to H-06) cover the rest; an autoplaying video and a built cart page each fail them by name.

**What is not built, and is specified instead.** The cart, search and account behind the placeholders. The README's *Scripting still needed* sets out each — state, availability checks, the transaction ceiling, the searchable fields and query rules, and why an account needs a back end — so the next build starts from a specification rather than from this discussion. The transaction ceiling is declared per entity as `maxTransactionUSD` and is `NEEDS-INPUT` on both routes: no figure for it has been established.

**The shop bar is icons only at every width.** The research in Section 6.2 favours visible words beside icons; the reference Priscilla chose shows icons alone, and that is what was built. Only the magnifying glass is close to universal. If the account or cart icon proves ambiguous in use, the labels are one CSS change away: the words are already in the markup.

Table 19: Scope status after the first build

| Phase                          | Status                                                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Data, photography and images | Built: views data, placeholders, thumbnails, size manifest, video pipeline, alt text audited. The shot list is in the README |
| 2 The gallery                  | Built, including the per-view lightbox and the extended render check                                                         |
| 3 The buy box and disclosures  | Not started                                                                                                                  |
| 4 Saved and selection          | Superseded by D1 and D3: the shop bar is built with placeholders; the cart is specified in the README                        |
| 5 Search                       | Superseded by D4: specified in the README, with no threshold                                                                 |
| 6 A real cart                  | Specified in the README; still depends on the provider confirming multi-item checkout                                        |

## 6.7 Implementation scope

Six phases, in order of dependency. Every item names the evidence that closes it; *done* means the check exists and passes, not that the page looks right. Sizes are relative: S is under a day, M a few days, L a week or more.

### 6.7.1 Phase 1 — Data, photography and images

| ID  | Work                                                                                                                                                                              | Done when                                                                      | Size |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 1.1 | <code>views[]</code> in <code>artworks.json</code> : <code>kind</code> , <code>image</code> , <code>bilingual alt</code> ; the existing <code>image</code> becomes the front view | The build reads both shapes; every work has a front view                       | S    |
| 1.2 | Shot list and lighting brief for detail, edge and back                                                                                                                            | A one-page brief Priscilla can follow with a phone                             | S    |
| 1.3 | <code>build-images.mjs</code> takes <code>masters/&lt;slug&gt;/&lt;kind&gt;</code> ; a 160 and 320 px thumbnail width                                                             | Every view resolves at every width; <code>check-links</code> covers them       | M    |
| 1.4 | The in-scale view rendered from dimensions as an image                                                                                                                            | Its proportions checked against <code>widthCm</code> and <code>heightCm</code> | M    |

| ID  | Work                                                                | Done when                                 | Size |
|-----|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------|
| 1.5 | NEEDS-INPUT audit covers views and their alt text in both languages | A missing view or alt is reported by name | S    |

### 6.7.2 Phase 2 — The gallery

| ID  | Work                                                                     | Done when                                                          | Size |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 2.1 | Scroll-snap strip and linked thumbnails, no script                       | Every view reachable with scripts off, by keyboard and by swipe    | M    |
| 2.2 | Rail from 900 px; row with a partly cut-off last thumbnail below         | Measured at 1440, 900, 390 and 360 px in <code>check-render</code> | S    |
| 2.3 | Enhancement: <code>aria-current</code> , no history per view, arrow keys | A review assertion for each; reduced motion honoured               | S    |
| 2.4 | Lightbox opens the current view                                          | One transition name per painting per page still holds (G-05)       | S    |
| 2.5 | Front view eager; other views lazy                                       | Only the front view is requested before interaction                | S    |
| 2.6 | <code>check-render</code> extended to every view and thumbnail           | No view distorted, rounded or transformed at any width             | S    |

### 6.7.3 Phase 3 — The buy box and disclosures

| ID  | Work                                                                    | Done when                                                                                     | Size |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 3.1 | Reorder the aside; Save and Add to selection beneath the primary action | The price is still the boldest element (N-03)                                                 | S    |
| 3.2 | Assurance lines generated from <code>seller.json</code>                 | No assurance string typed into a template                                                     | S    |
| 3.3 | Duty estimate linked by destination                                     | Every destination in Table 10 reachable                                                       | M    |
| 3.4 | <details> disclosures                                                   | Operable by keyboard; content present with styles off                                         | S    |
| 3.5 | Payment methods from the active entity                                  | Built with <code>hk-sole-prop</code> , card marks appear; with <code>individual</code> , none | S    |
| 3.6 | Share sheet with copy-link fallback                                     | Works with the API absent; no third-party share scripts                                       | S    |
| 3.7 | More works: three available, never sold                                 | A sold work never appears                                                                     | S    |

### 6.7.4 Phase 4 — Saved and selection

| ID  | Work                                                                  | Done when                                                       | Size |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 4.1 | Masthead: short name and icons on phones; labels from 900 px          | No overflow at 360 px; accessible names match labels (2.5.3)    | M    |
| 4.2 | Saved: device storage, <code>/saved/</code> page in both locales      | Works with storage blocked; nothing leaves the browser          | M    |
| 4.3 | Selection: <code>/selection/</code> page, total, one composed enquiry | The enquiry lists every work; the page says nothing is reserved | M    |
| 4.4 | Both re-check <code>availability.json</code> on open                  | A work sold since saving is shown as sold                       | S    |
| 4.5 | Privacy page notes on-device storage                                  | Reviewed against Section 4.3                                    | S    |

### 6.7.5 Phase 5 — Search, at the threshold

| ID  | Work                                 | Done when                                                   | Size |
|-----|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 5.1 | Build-time index in both languages   | Rebuilt with the site; size reported                        | S    |
| 5.2 | Search control and results page      | Chinese and English queries both find titles and media      | M    |
| 5.3 | The switch in <code>site.json</code> | The control is absent below the threshold, present above it | S    |

### 6.7.6 Phase 6 — A real cart, only if D3 says so

| ID  | Work                                                                 | Done when                                       | Size |
|-----|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------|
| 6.1 | Confirm the provider takes several line items in one hosted checkout | Written confirmation, as for item 5 in Table 20 | —    |
| 6.2 | Selection becomes a cart                                             | One payment covers every work in it             | L    |
| 6.3 | Overselling defence extended to carts                                | A work in two carts cannot be paid for twice    | M    |
| 6.4 | Order confirmation and withdrawal information per order              | Reviewed against Section 4.1 and Section 4.2    | M    |

Throughout: the report updated with each phase, screenshots re-taken by `shots.sh`, and nothing marked done without its check.

## 6.8 A verification fault found while scoping

Measuring the masthead for Table 16 turned up a fault in how this project had been checking phone layouts. **Headless Chrome will not lay a page out narrower than 500 px.** Asked for 390 px, it lays the page out at 500 and the screenshot simply crops the left 390. Every headless “390 px” result before this part — including the phone screenshot in Section 2.7 and the 390 px pass of `check-render.mjs` — was a 500 px layout.

Phone widths are now measured inside an `iframe` of exactly that width, which is a true viewport, and `check-render` asserts the width it actually received. A second trap followed immediately: inside the `iframe` Chrome drew a 15 px desktop scrollbar, so “360 px” left

345 px for the page and appeared to show the language switch wrapping onto its own line. No phone has that scrollbar; with it hidden the masthead fits, and the check now measures *content* width so the same artefact would fail loudly instead of passing as a finding. `check-render` now covers 1440, 900, 390 and 360 px, and a defect confined to widths under 400 px — which the old check could not see — fails it by name.

## PART 7

## Open items

Five places where the evidence is thinner than the recommendation resting on it. Every one needs a person outside this project — a customs broker, a tax adviser, a carrier, Airwallex — and none can be closed by writing more code.

Table 20: Unresolved, in rough order of cost if wrong

| # | Item                                    | Status                                                               | What to do                                                           |
|---|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Cultural-relics export appraisal        | <b>Not established.</b> Chinese government sources unreachable       | Confirm a living artist's new work is not 文物 before the first export |
| 2 | EU reduced art VAT rates                | <b>Unverified.</b> Directive (EU) 2022/542 changed art VAT from 2025 | Do not publish per-country rates yet                                 |
| 3 | Carrier costs and insurance from China  | No verified figures                                                  | Needed before the shipping page is final                             |
| 4 | Export declaration for a \$300 painting | Not established                                                      | Also determines what supports the bank's FX check                    |
| 5 | Airwallex + HK sole proprietorship      | Entity list verified for account opening only                        | Ask before incorporating                                             |

### 7.1 Closed since the first draft

Three items that were open have been settled in the build itself.

Table 21: Closed, and where

| Item                            | Resolution                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Where                                   |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| CJK webfont strategy            | The display face is subset to the ~100 characters that appear in headings, work titles and UI labels: <b>34 KB, from a 24 MB face.</b> <code>unicode-range</code> gates the fetch, so an English page never downloads it, and a character added before the next build falls through to the system face rather than rendering as tofu. Chinese body prose is deliberately not webfont-served. | <code>scripts/build-fonts-cjk.py</code> |
| Leonardo's hatching angle       | Recorded in the stylesheet as a measurement rather than a citation, with the caveat that two chalk sheets ran the other way                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <code>src/styles/base.css</code>        |
| Mona Lisa glaze layer count     | The thickness is cited; the count is not, and the comment says why                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <code>src/styles/tokens.css</code>      |
| No logo                         | A mark that carries no letterforms, so one file serves both locales, generated from a single geometry for the tab, the home screen, the masthead and this document                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <code>scripts/mark.mjs</code>           |
| The report's own Chinese subset | Was built by hand, with <code>cjk-chars.txt</code> recording what somebody had built and nothing checking it still matched the prose. It is now derived from the <code>.qmd</code> on every build, and instanced to Regular first — subsetting the variable original silently yields <b>ExtraLight</b> , which is what the statutory quotations would have been set in                       | <code>docs/report/fonts.py</code>       |

| Item                     | Resolution                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Where                    |
|--------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Phone-width verification | Headless Chrome lays out at no less than 500 px, so every "390 px" check and capture had been a cropped 500 px layout. Phone widths are now laid out in an iframe of the stated width and the received width is asserted (Section 6.8) | scripts/check-render.mjs |
| The report's screenshots | Were taken by hand in a section that claims to show what the build produces. Now taken from dist/by script                                                                                                                             | docs/report/shots.sh     |

## 7.2 Content still outstanding

The build reports every placeholder; 98 fields are still `NEEDS-INPUT`, 48 of them the alt text owed for the new views. The blocking ones are the photographs, the titles and descriptions, and the contact details — the email and phone are not optional, they are the consumer-law requirement in Section 4.2.

One design item is also still open. The Chinese-locale enquiry route should be WeChat rather than a `mailto:`, and that needs a QR image that does not exist yet; the label was fixed, the channel was not.

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## Appendix: sources and method

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**Colour.** Ratios computed with the WCAG 2 relative-luminance formula. The draft's values were extracted from the PDF content stream rather than sampled from a render, so they are declared values. Figures in this document read the project's live token file.

**Fonts.** Built with fonttools 4.59.1 from the variable originals; byte counts are measured output, not estimates.

**Reachability from mainland China.** Measured against a GFW measurement service, with known-blocked controls validating the method before any result was accepted.

**Regulatory material.** Chinese provisions read from `gov.cn` and `safe.gov.cn`; EU instruments from the Publications Office; US tariff treatment from the HTSUS and the Federal Register. Article numbers are given so each can be checked.

**Layout.** Verified by headless screenshot at 1440 px and at phone widths, not by description. Before Section 6.8, headless captures labelled 390 px were 500 px layouts cropped to 390; phone widths are now laid out in an iframe of the stated width. Three defects were found that way and are recorded in the commit history. The captures in Section 2.7 are taken from `dist/` by `docs/report/shots.sh` as part of this document's build, so they cannot show a version of the site that is no longer shipping.

**The mark.** Figure 3 and the mark in this document's footer are both drawn from `mark.mjs`, the one file the site's icons and its masthead are generated from. The TikZ copy of those numbers in the preamble is checked against it on every build. The hanging figure of 144.78 cm is the museum standard already used by the scale diagram on every work page.

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